

For this person, storage stops being just personal and starts becoming operational. Microsoft's higher Microsoft 365 plans become attractive here because they include larger OneDrive allocations and workflow features tied to Office and Windows, while Google One suits people who run their business communication and files through Gmail and Drive. The point is not just capacity; it is frictionless backup of work that cannot be recreated cheaply.

If you earn money from your laptop, too little storage is not frugal. It is risky.

The creator: assume 1TB early, 2TB sooner than you think

This is the territory where amateur logic dies.

If you shoot in RAW, record 4K often, capture long clips, maintain project exports, or use iPhone ProRes even occasionally, your storage growth can become violent. Apple's support documentation on ProRes and the ProRes codec family exists precisely because these formats are designed for high image quality and correspondingly large data rates. You do not need to memorize megabits per second to understand the takeaway: creators should plan for large files from day one, not after their first "why is my storage gone?" moment.

For creators, 1TB is not an excess. It is often the minimum comfortable tier once projects accumulate. And 2TB arrives sooner than expected if your cloud is also holding photos, phone backups, documents, and archived finished work.

Step-by-step: how creators should plan storage

1. Check your largest file type: RAW photos, 4K video, ProRes, PSD, audio, layouts.
2. Estimate how much you create per month.
3. Multiply by 12 for one year.
4. Add archive room for finished work you still need.
5. Then add personal files on top.

This is not pessimism. It is arithmetic.



SO WHAT SHOULD MOST READERS BUY?

Here is the blunt recommendation.

If you are a solo casual user, start with 50GB or 100GB, depending on platform and email load. If you are a student or normal phone-and-laptop user, 100GB is often the smart middle ground. If you are a family sharing photos and backups, 200GB is often the real entry point, with 2TB for heavier households.

If you are a freelancer, hybrid worker or creator, think in 1TB to 2TB terms much earlier.

The main thing to avoid is false thrift. A backup plan that is constantly full is not a backup plan. It is a monthly argument waiting to happen.

A practical formula for choosing your plan

Use this simple model:

Current used space

- one year of expected growth
 - safety buffer for sudden spikes
- = your actual plan target

That safety buffer matters more than people think. A wedding month, a travel month, a child's school annual day, a freelance project, or a phone upgrade can all create sudden storage spikes.

Step-by-step: do a 10-minute storage audit

1. Open your cloud account and check total used space.
 2. See which category is largest: mail, photos, files, backups, chats.
 3. Check your phone's photo/video count.
 4. Open WhatsApp's Manage Storage tools.
 5. Estimate whether the next 12 months will be heavier or lighter than the last 12.
 6. Choose the smallest plan that covers that reality comfortably.
- This is how you stop buying storage emotionally.

And the other thing to avoid is false ambition. Do not buy 2TB just because it sounds "future-proof" if your actual digital life is mostly PDFs, some notes and 1,200 photos. Cloud storage should feel roomy, not absurd.

The sweet spot is this: buy enough space that backups keep working quietly in the background, but not so much that you stop caring what goes into them. Because the goal is not to hoard everything forever. The goal is to protect what matters, preserve what is useful, and stop paying rent to thousands of files you will never look at again. 